



Catch up with Startups Weekly

Your weekly dose of startup insights and innovation, delivered right to your inbox.

SIGN UP NOW

[I don't want startup news.](#)

A cloud-seeding startup
did not cause the Texas
floods



Catch up with Startups Weekly

Your weekly dose of startup insights and innovation, delivered right to your inbox.

SIGN UP NOW

I don't want startup news.

- Roku launches Howdy, a \$2.99 ad-free streaming service
- Spotify raises subscription prices
- The uproar over Vogue's AI-generated ad isn't just about fashion

water droplets — water that remains liquid below the freezing point — they trigger the droplets to freeze into ice. That freezing is important, Rauber said. Ice crystals grow in size faster than super-cooled water drops, meaning they are more likely to capture enough water vapor to become large enough to fall out of the cloud. If they had remained as super-cooled water, there's a good chance they would eventually evaporate.

- Your public ChatGPT queries are getting indexed by Google and other search engines
- The best dating apps aren't even dating apps



Catch up with Startups Weekly

Your weekly dose of startup insights and innovation, delivered right to your inbox.

SIGN UP NOW

I don't want startup news.

In the U.S., most cloud seeding occurs in the winter near mountain ranges in the West. There, clouds form as the mountains push the air higher, causing it to cool and the water vapor to condense. If properly seeded, such clouds will release some of that water as snow, which is then held captive as snowpack, forming a natural reservoir that, during

spring melts, replenishes artificial reservoirs held behind dams.

Though people have been seeding clouds for decades, its impact on precipitation is a newer area of study. “We really didn’t have the technologies to evaluate it until recently,” Rauber said.

In early 2017, Friedrich, Rauber, and their colleagues



Catch up with Startups Weekly

Your weekly dose of startup insights and innovation, delivered right to your inbox.

SIGN UP NOW

[I don't want startup news.](#)

For starters, the company was seeding nearby clouds days before the storm hit. “The air that was over that area two days before was probably somewhere over Canada by the time that storm occurred,” Rauber said.

Second, it’s not clear whether cloud seeding is as effective in the cumulus clouds that occur in Texas

In the summer. They're distinct from the orographic clouds that form near mountain ranges, and they don't respond the same to cloud seeding. For one, they tend to be short-lived and don't produce a lot of precipitation.

Cloud seeders might try to coax more out of them anyway, but "the amount of rain that comes out of those seeded clouds is small," Rauber said.

Those t
deep, li
are just
efficient
anything

Topics:



Catch up with Startups Weekly

Your weekly dose of startup insights and innovation, delivered right to your inbox.

SIGN UP NOW

I don't want startup news.



TechCrunch

Staff

Contact Us

Advertise

Terms of
Service

Privacy
Policy

RSS Terms of
Use

OpenAI

Perplexity

Cisco

DeepMind

Windsurf

Tech Layoffs





Catch up with Startups Weekly

Your weekly dose of startup insights and innovation, delivered right to your inbox.

SIGN UP NOW

I don't want startup news.